

Capstone-Fit Questions

Day 1 handout. Five questions to confirm your capstone subject survives contact with a 4-day build. Some declared candidates won't. If 1+ answer is "no," refine the subject or pick your backup — better now than Wednesday. Your Week-8 capstone subject is your choice: **FieldPulse** or **an internal project of your own** (your actual work, school, or a hobby).

The 5 capstone-fit questions

1. **Real customer?** Do we have a real customer — interviews, observation, or data — not just a guess?
2. **Substantive enough?** Is the scope substantive enough that compressed PRD work has real substance to work on?
3. **Clear problem?** Can you state the core problem in one sentence an engineer could scope from — not just a solution or a feature?
4. **Discussable publicly?** Can we discuss it publicly — no NDA or IP issues?
5. **Shippable in 4 days?** Can we ship the full artifact set in 4 days (Day 2–4 build + Day 5 present)?

How to use it

1. **Re-read your declared candidate** (from end of Week 7). What did you commit to?
2. **Walk the 5 questions** honestly as a triad.
3. **Adjust or commit.** If 1+ question is "no," refine the subject or switch to a backup.
4. **List the inputs you'll need** before tomorrow's discovery — customer interviews, data, docs, system access.

Watch-outs

- A subject that fails "**substantive enough**" produces a thin capstone. Pick something richer.
- A subject with no real customer signal produces a *fictional* PRD. Get at least one real interview — even a 15-minute phone call counts.

Output

A confirmed capstone subject in one sentence + a list of discovery inputs to gather before Day 2.